

Android also supports a plethora of additional components, such as gyroscopes, pressure sensors, cameras, touchscreen, etc., and All of them connect seamlessly with the software and allow apps to access them all easily. Because of the sheer versatility of Android, it's not just phones that run it, but everything from car multimedia systems, tablets, set-top boxes, TVs, home alarm systems, and pretty much any device that has humans interfacing with it can be run on Android. This is because its main kernel doesn't really require any specific hardware peripherals to boot. Heck, you can run Android on a PC with keyboard and mouse if you wanted to, and is already easily emulated on x86 architectures using virtualisation. There was even an Android based gaming console, but we'll get to that later if we have the space.

The most common way to interface with Android is via a user interface that uses direct manipulation (usually touch controls). Of course, this is not totally necessary, and game controllers and even full size keyboards are supported via bluetooth or mini USB. It's truly a dream OS for anyone looking to innovate in the hardware space.

The framework is designed so that installed applications can easily access data from various peripherals and provide new functionalities – such as real-time weather updates or 'accelerometric' updates (e.g. Snapchat).

Android is built with customisation in mind, because no two users need to have the same UI – they can choose to, but they don't have to. It's also extremely flexible, and for example, Google's project Daydream (announced



The Google Cardboard aims at using the smartphone to provide an immersive VR experience